



iTunes, not again

iTunes users may seldom complain about its sluggish performance and how its not the best music management application, however the truth is that



iTunes revolutionized the way we listen to our music on the go. It all began when SoundJam MP was purchased in 1999 by Apple and was released in 2001 under a new name - iTunes. However it wasn't until 2004 when iTunes got it's true identity. Major GUI changes were made to the program and along came the famous cover flow design which has inspired a lot of user interfaces ever since. iTunes also brought along with it the whole idea of purchasing a song for 99 cents. This wasn't heavy on the pocket and listeners resorted to this new way of buying music rather than downloading illegally. Apart from syncing music, videos and podcasts the Genius feature got added in 2008 which now recommended songs based on your listening taste. There might be better music managers than iTunes out there but this is where it all began.



Goopy

Back in the days when Steve Jobs was invited by Xerox to their office, they showed him three things. First was object oriented programming, the second thing was a network of about a hundred Alto computers all using email, but it was the third thing which left Jobs speechless it was GUI. Jobs stealing Xerox's idea and implementing it on Apple machines is all



part of history now. GUI has played a major role in the way we interact not only with our computers but also with our mobile devices, our MP3 players, GPS devices and so on. GUIs that are common for both PCs and tablets is where the wave seems to be heading, especially with the Windows 8 metro style GUI which is tablet ready. A similar interface was used in Zune MP3 players and now Windows phone 7 ships with it.



Piracy

Ever since the dawn of the Internet, piracy has spread its wings and ruled the underbellies of the world wide web. We doubt there's anyone out there who hasn't indulged in any sort of piracy till now? However harsh piracy might be on software and programme developers it's always the consumers of cracked applications who walk away laughing. Back in the early nineties annual loss



to software companies from piracy was a staggering 15 billion dollars, this number now stands at more than 50 billion and most of it comes from the Asia region. We all love our websites which have a pirate ship on it but that doesn't stop the copyright laws in our country to get more stringent.



File system

File system organises and retains data in a hierarchical structure enabling it to be retrieved later once the program is terminated. It also controls



the naming convention of files authorising which characters can be used and how long the name of the file can be. Both the operating system and the file system are closely tied where some file systems provide access to the data and metadata. Data storage devices such as hard disk drives, optical discs and flash memory all use file systems. File allocation table (FAT) file system which was originally developed for the DOS system was held up in 2006 due to issues in its patents.



R.M.S

Expanded as Richard Matthew Stallman better known as a software hippie is an advocate of free software. Stallman has been the brain behind the GNU project whose main aim



has been to develop sufficient amount of software so that users may never need to pay for it. He's also the president and founder of Free Software Foundation (www.fsf.org). Witty guy that he is our last conversation with him resulted in this 'I am located somewhere on Earth, but as far as responding to email is concerned, I appear to be well outside the solar system'.

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\$ 2.9 billion is the amount that companies lose due to software piracy annually and this is just from the developing countries. In UK Business Software Alliance offers a bounty of 20,000 pounds to employees who inform of their company's illegitimate software practices